

VER. 26.1

Authenticity

Sabatons

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1. Implementation

The document has been created and approved by the General Assembly of 09.11.2024.
The document and its rules have been implemented since the 2025 season.

2. Definition

"**Sabatons**" is the term used to describe all foot protections.

Types of Greaves:

- **Plate Sabatons**
  Made of metal plates riveted together, it is the most effective and the most common foot protection over all Middle Ages.
- **Brigand Sabaton**
  Made of metal plates riveted to a leather base. This protection is not commonly represented in historical sources. The plates are covered by the leather.
- **Scales Sabatons**
  Made of small scales riveted upon a leather base. This protection is not commonly represented in historical sources.
- **Chainmail Sabatons**
  The protection of the foot is ensured by chainmail. This is the earliest foot protection documented by historical sources.
- **Eastern Sabatons**
  Due to very few historical sources, we allow eastern stylization of European Sabatons. Allowed designs are displayed in the "*Eastern Armors*" document.

3. General Requirements

All types of Sabatons must:

- be based on historical sources,
- have an anatomical shape of the foot,
- reproduce the proportions based on historical sources,

Any metal part of the Sabatons must conform to the "*Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations*" document.

Any textile or leather part of the Sabatons must conform to the "*Textiles and Leather"* document.

4. Plate sabatons

4.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Plate Sabatons are mainly represented from the mid-14th century to very late armors of the 15th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century**, **Transitional** and **15th century armors.**



Köln - 1375 - Germany



BL Sloane 2683 Book of Hours - 1390/1399 - Belgium



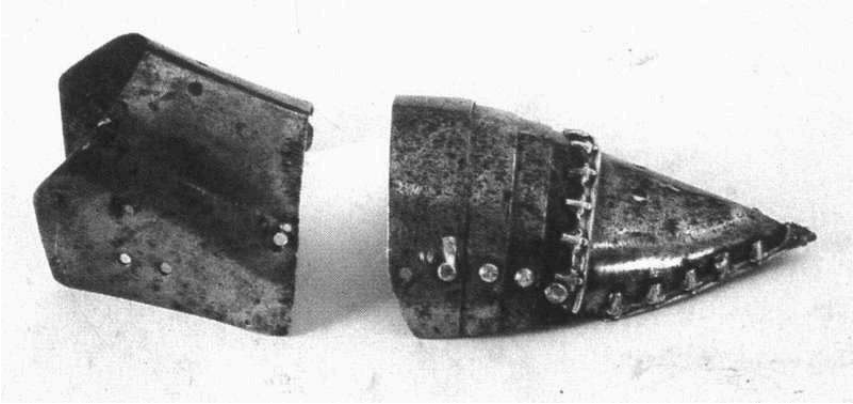
E. of Woodstock - 1376 - England

4.2. Specific Requirements

Plate Sabatons must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

Plate Sabatons must have at least 5 segments.

➢ *Example:*



It is allowed to add heel protection.

➢ *Example:*



Plate Sabatons must have a pointed shape.

➢ *Example:*



Maximilian style armors of the 16th century can have square-shaped Sabatons.

➢ *Example:*



4.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©



Picture from Age of Craft ©

5. Brigand Sabatons

5.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Brigand Sabatons are not well represented in historical sources. They are displayed in sources from the middle of the 14th century.

They are **Approved** for **14th century armors**.

They are **Denied** for **Transitional and 15th century armors**.



G. von Schwarzburg - 1349 - Germany

5.2. Specific Requirements

Brigand Sabatons must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

Brigand Sabatons must be made of metal plates.

The plates must be firmly-riveted to a leather base.

The plates must be riveted from the inside of the leather base.

5.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

6. Scale Sabatons

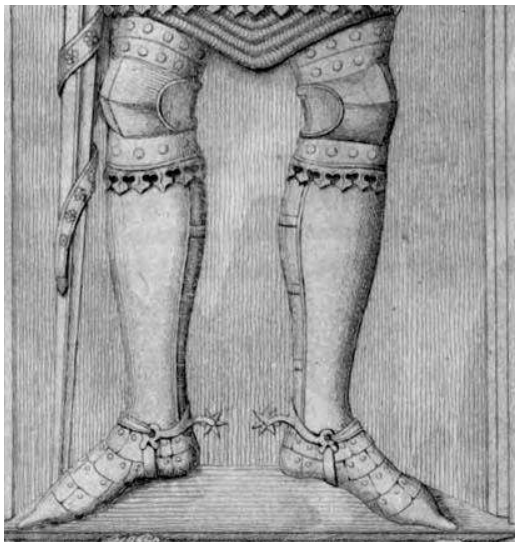
6.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Scales Sabatons are not well represented in historical sources. They are displayed in sources from 1350 to 1395.

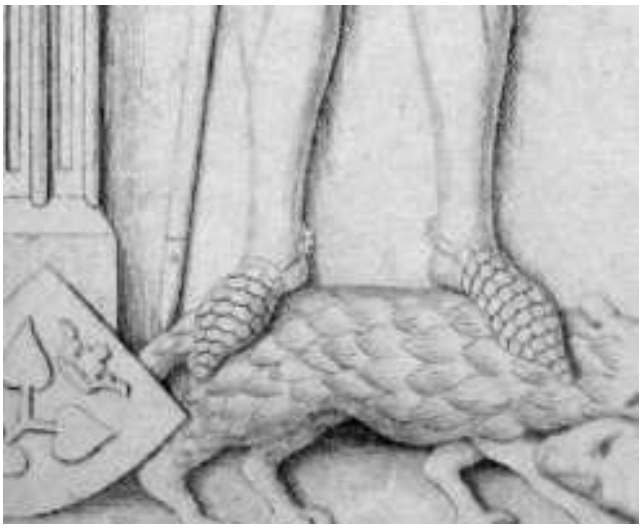
They are **Approved** for **14th century** and **Transitional armors**.

They are **Denied** for **15th century armor**.

Their construction makes scale Sabatons less protective than plate Sabatons. Therefore, we do not recommend such Sabatons in any category.



J. von Falkenstein- 1365 - Germany



Guda von Bellersheim - 1394 - Germany

6.2. Specific Requirements

Scales Sabatons must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

The scales can have a rectangular shape or a rounded shape.

The scales must be firmly attached to the shoe with rivets or leather thread

Scale Sabatons must have a pointed shape.

6.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

7. Chainmail Sabatons

7.1. Historical Sources and Datation

Chainmail Sabatons are the earliest foot protection. They were popular in the 13th and early 14th century, and were replaced by more protective Sabatons around the middle of the 14th century. They are still in use in very rare cases during the 15th century.

They are **Approved** for 14th century armors and Transitional.

They are **Approved** for 15th century armors **if documented by sources.** We encourage you to send an email to the authenticity committee before purchasing such Sabatons and armors.

Their construction makes chainmail Sabatons less protective than plate Sabatons. Therefore, we do not recommend such Sabatons in any category.



Pfarr- und Klosterkirche Sankt Lampert, Seeon-Seebruck, Bavaria - 1395 - Germany

7.2. Specific Requirements

Chainmail Sabatons must conform to the General Requirements (see Section 3 above).

It is mandatory to use plate segments as the main protection, and use chainmail only for articulation purposes.

It is strongly recommended to use plate Sabatons as it is the best protection you can use for your foot.

7.3. Examples of Approved Reproductions



Picture from Medieval Extreme ©

8. Changelog

Below, we will keep track of all the changes made over the lifetime of this document. This way, all our members can see how the documents are changing over time.

January - 2026 (V. 26.1)
Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Add: “1. Implementation” (and subsequent modification of all Title numbers in the document)
Clarification:
- Split of “1. Definition and general requirements” in “2. Definition and description ” and “3. General Requirements”. **This split doesn’t have an impact on the content of the rules.**

December-2024: -Add
Document has been created